Save the Children

Youth Employment & Job Linkage Impact Analysis

Study Protocol: Cohort 1 Analysis

Analyzing job search behaviors and employment outcomes for youth receiving "Job-Linkage Only" interventions (Class of 2026)

Skills to Succeed | GG12 China Program

Research Background & Objectives

Research Objectives

- Measure the shifts in perceived readiness and technical job search proficiency (resumes, preparedness for interviews, job search strategies) following the interventions.
- Identify where the 2026 cohort faces the most significant challenges—from application to interview or interview to offer.
- Determine if specific activities are more strongly correlated with # of job applications, # of job interviews, time to employment, or gaining employment.
- Evaluate the employment outcomes of the 2026 cohort by quantifying their labor market status and analyzing the quality of secured roles through indicators of average wages, contract formality, and employer-provided benefits.

Intervention Design

Target Population

1,000 third-year students (expected graduation: June 2026) from 1–3 project schools.

Total Dosage: ~5 hours

Pre-engagement: Diagnostic phase to tailor activities

Online Live Sessions: 1.5-2 hours virtual training on resume development

Career Carnival: In-person event with AI mock interviews, simulations, employer stations

Research Questions

Q1

How do participants distribute their engagement across the various "Career Carnival" activities, and does this distribution vary by gender or academic major?

Q2

To what extent does the intervention increase participants' job search efficacy (confidence in searching, applying, and interviewing) from baseline to follow up?

Q3

Following the intervention, how many search methods do participants utilize on average, and does this variety correlate with the number of interviews secured?

Q4

What is the average "Time-to-Placement" for participants, and does this vary by which activities they chose to attend?

Q5

What are the characteristics of the jobs secured by the 2026 cohort in terms of starting wage, contract formality, benefits, and alignment with their field of study?

Q6

At which stage of the job search process do most students encounter the greatest obstacle: getting invited to an interview after applying, or receiving a final offer after being interviewed?

Data Collection: US vs CN Approach

US Approach

Sampling strategy with 400 final sample (200 Male, 200 Female). Initial recruitment of 650, tracking through activities with 25% attrition assumption.

CN Approach

Census approach (1000 youth in intervention cohort). Baseline survey with 90% response rate, follow-up accounting for 25% attrition.

Stage	US	CN	Notes
Initial Recruitment	650	1,000	CN: Census approach; US: Sampled with consent at intake
Baseline Survey	650	~900	CN: 90% response rate for voluntary participation
Activity Completion	500	—	US: Traced through activities; 25% attrition assumed
Follow-up Survey	400	~675	Valid N for final analysis; CN: 25% attrition from baseline

Part 1: Cohort 1 Analysis Summary

Focus

Analyzing job search behaviors and employment outcomes for youth receiving "Job-Linkage Only" interventions (Class of 2026)

Target Population

1,000 third-year students (expected graduation: June 2026) from 1–3 project schools

Intervention Dosage

~5 hours via three-stage model: Pre-engagement, Online Live Sessions (1.5-2h), Career Carnival

Key Measurements

- Resume & Interview Readiness Shifts
- Time-to-Placement
- Application-to-Interview Conversion Rate
- Employment Quality (wages, contract, benefits)
- Interview-to-Offer Conversion Rate

CN Data Collection Strategy: Census approach with baseline survey (~900 respondents, 90% response rate) and follow-up survey (~675 respondents, accounting for 25% attrition)

Part 2: Cohort Comparison Summary

Focus

Measuring the additional benefits of employability skills training (Cohort 2 vs. Cohort 1)

Target Population

Current 2nd year students; Graduation in June 2027 (2,450 youth total; 1,800 youth from the same schools as the Class of 2026)

Research Objectives

- Determine the statistical difference in placement rates and job search strategies and skills when employability training is added to job linkages.
- Examine whether the addition of employability skills empower youth to secure better-quality roles. Compare "decent work" indicators such as starting wages, contract formality, benefits.
- Analyze whether the addition of employability skills training is more or less effective for female participants compared to their male counterparts.

CN Data Collection Strategy: Census of 1,800 youth with baseline survey (~1,620) and follow-up survey (~1,215)